

## SymPy Bug Card

### Bug 24: solveset returns 1 for $\operatorname{asec}(x) = 2\pi$ outside the principal $\operatorname{asec}$ range

**Task.** Solve the inverse-secant equation over the complex domain:

$$\operatorname{asec}(x) = 2\pi.$$

**SymPy's answer.**

$$\operatorname{solveset}(\operatorname{asec}(x) = 2\pi, x, \mathbb{C}) = \{1\}.$$

**Correct answer.**

$$\emptyset.$$

**Explanation.** Substitution rejects the returned value:  $\operatorname{asec}(1) - 2\pi = -2\pi$ . Principal inverse secant satisfies  $\operatorname{asec}(1) = \arccos(1) = 0$ , so applying  $\sec$  to both sides has introduced an extraneous solution.

**Likely root cause.** The diagnosis identifies `sympy/solvers/solveset.py`'s generic `.inverse()` path in `_invert_complex`:  $\operatorname{asec}^{-1}$  is treated as  $\sec$  without a principal-range check or final candidate verification. This is a new instance of a known failure mode.

**Artifact (GitHub).** [bug-report/bug-024-solveset-returns-1-for-asec-x-2-pi-outside-the-principal-ase/](#)